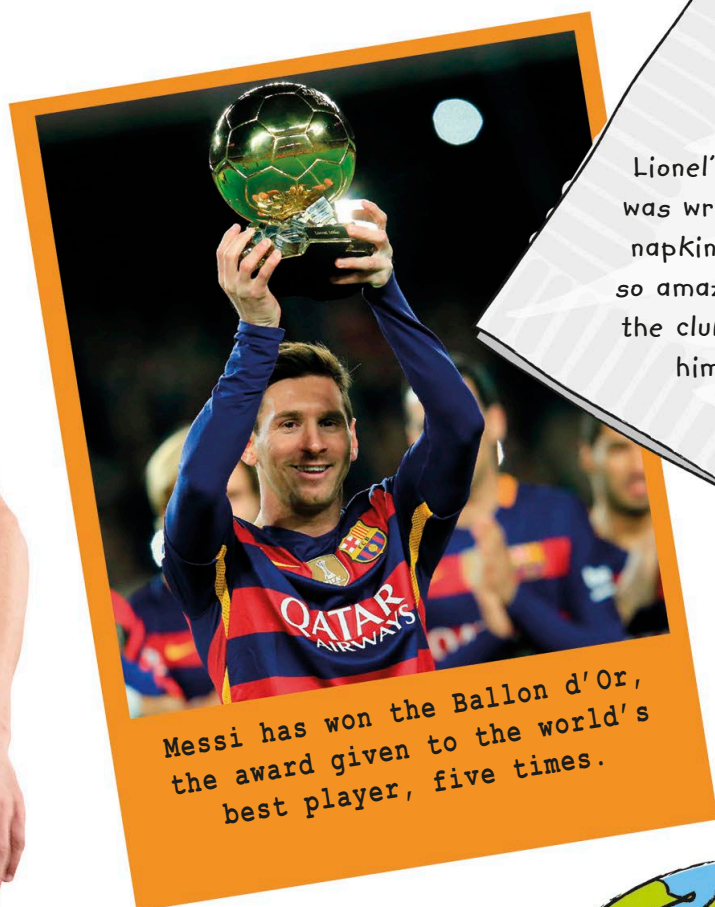




Messi has won the Ballon d'Or, the award given to the world's best player, five times.



Lionel's first contract was written on a paper napkin! Barcelona was so amazed at his talent, the club wanted to sign him right away.

Lionel moved to Spain and signed with Barcelona. The rest is history!



Career of a champion

Lionel made his debut for Barcelona at age 17 and has gone on to win a staggering number of titles with the club, including the Spanish league title 10 times and the Champions League four times.

in his career with **Barcelona.**

Career highlights



91



In 2012, he scored 91 goals for Barcelona and Argentina.

9

He has won the award for the best player in the Spanish league a record nine times.

400

He is the only player to score more than 400 goals in the Spanish league.

68



He is Argentina's all-time top goal scorer, with 68.

21

In 2012 and 2013, he scored in 21 Spanish league matches in a row.



Like many soccer legends, he wears the number 10.